for some seats contested by BJP alliance partners. UP BJP office-bearers analysed from party list issued on 23 August 2020. UP BJP government ministers' list is accurate as of 30 October 2020. UP BJP district presidents' list is based on party listing as of 25 July 2020.

These numbers revealed by the Mehta–Singh Index showcase why it is misleading to characterise the new BJP under Modi and Shah as a party dominated by upper castes. In reality, it is quite the reverse. The BJP, between 2013 and 2019, saw a remaking of not only its social-support base but also of its internal organisational systems with OBCs being given centre stage. In a state where OBCs are 54.5 per cent and SCs 20.7 per cent of the population,[10] the BJP was ahead of all major political parties in proportionally representing candidates from these castes in the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha polls and inching closer towards it in other political structures. The BJP in UP, after 2013, put up significantly more OBCs as candidates than its political rivals: SP, BSP and Congress. It also gave them more space in its internal power structures in the state, radically shifting its organisational DNA. This internal change was reflected in the upward swing in its political fortunes. To be sure, upper castes, which number about 24.2 per cent in UP, are still over-represented and remain integral to the party, but the proportion is much less than before.[11] The BJP's pattern of mobilisation is also in complete contrast with Congress-dominant UP in the pre-1989 era, well documented by scholars like Jaffrelot and Zoya Hasan.[12] It is also at variance with the pre-1990s Janata Party, or SP and BSP (from the 1990s) whose political fulcrum revolved around core OBC or SC groups while aggregating others. The great increase in representation of OBCs and SCs in the BJP's structures changed the perception of the party on the ground, in relation to its explicitly caste-based political opponents: SP (with OBCs) and BSP (with Dalits). What matters in politics is not necessarily absolute numbers but change: the perception and direction of it. Here, the direction of change in the BJP and how it started sharing power with castes that had been relatively ignored by national parties is unmistakeable.

In this regard, the most striking feature of the new BJP is the rising representation of women in the UP state-level leadership. Women accounted for 23.8 per cent of the BJP's state-level office-